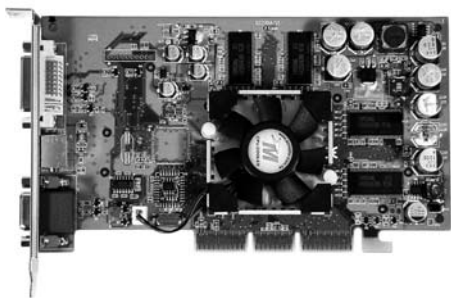


Such graphics cards should have a temperature sensor that can be viewed from within the operating system. This would give you a good indication of whether the card is overheating. Unless you are



A graphics processor card with a fan

stressing out the system with high-end 3D applications for hours on end, it is unlikely that the graphics card is your source of trouble. In most cases it would be the power supply. But the sudden freeze and shut down is typical of overheating, so look at the CPU and PSU again if you have ruled out the graphics card as the source of the problem.

3.4 Troubleshooting AGP

The AGP expansion slot was introduced to overcome the speed limitations of PCI on the graphics sub-system. The AGP slot is a modified version of the 66 MHz 32-bit PCI Slot. If AGP is disabled, the slot reverts to being a PCI slot. Initially, AGP 1x and 2x provided twice and four times the speed of PCI respectively. AGP 2.0 introduced Fast Writes and a 4x speed while reducing the signalling voltage. With AGP 3.0, the speed got pushed up to 8x and further reduced the signalling voltage.

On most computers, AGP works without a hitch. However, a significant number of PCs face problems with the AGP port.

► **Problems with instability:** Typical symptoms include random crashes in 3D mode, instantaneous crashes or hangs when entering 3D mode, image corruption, monitor blanking, computer freezes, and just about every other symptom that you might face with a video card.